FLYING CARS: A DREAM COME TRUE

[1] AeroMobil 3.0 is a combination of a plane and a car designed to drive on the road and fly through the air. It can transform in seconds from a car to a plane. **This invention** of the Slovakian company AeroMobil started to be on sale in 2017.

[2] The concept of a flying car is not new. The idea was popularized in the 1960s through animated cartoons. This concept was originally brought to life in 1989 by Slovak designer Stefan Klein. After years of testing different models, Klein's twenty-year dream came true when he set up a partnership with entrepreneur, Juraj Vaculik. They co-founded the company AeroMobil in 2010.

[3] Developing the flying car has not been without difficulties. AeroMobil company faced problems in 2015 when one of its prototypes crashed during a test in Nitra, west Slovakia, sending the pilot to hospital with minor injuries.

[4] The year 2016 was a great success for AeroMobil. **It** marked the introduction of the latest prototype AeroMobil 3.0 at an international forum in Brussels. The vehicle uses a diesel engine and has wings that fold, which allows it to be parked like a car, though it is nearly 6 meters long. It seats two people: the pilot and a passenger. The company said the car's top speed on the road is 160 km/h and 200 km/h while flying. It can fly for 700 kilometers before running out of fuel. Drivers who can buy this luxurious flying car, priced between 1.2 and 1.6 million dollars, will need a pilot's license to fly it.

[5] AeroMobil aims to make personal transportation more efficient and environmentally friendly. It helps to overcome traffic jams in large areas and allows faster travel for medium distances or in areas with limited road infrastructure.

[6] Stefan Klein is very positive about the project. "I'm very happy with what we have been able to achieve in such a short time with a team of only 12 engineers. AeroMobil 3.0 is not the end of this challenging project; it's the beginning of a whole new adventure which may change the way we look at personal transport in the future," he said.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. ARE THESE STATEMENTS TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. AeroMobil 3.0 can quickly change to a plane.

……

2. Both Juraj Vaculik and Stefan Klein set up the AeroMobil company.

……

3. During the test of AeroMobil 3.0 in 2015, the pilot was hurt in an accident.

……

B. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING CHART WITH INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

Technical Name of vehicle	Price	Top speed as a car	Top speed as a plane	Maximum nonstop flight
AeroMobil 3.0	……	……	……	……

C. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. Where was the latest AeroMobil 3.0 prototype introduced?

……

2. What do drivers need to fly AeroMobil 3.0?

……

3. How does Stefan Klein feel about the future of AeroMobil project?

……

D. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING SENTENCES. (2 pts)

1. Twelve engineers participated in ……

……

2. It is easy for AeroMobil 3.0 to be parked because ……..

……

E. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. This invention (paragraph 1): . . . . . .

2. It (paragraph 4): . . . .

F. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS OR PHRASES THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS (3 pts)

1. mixture (paragraph 1): . . . . . .

2. born (paragraph 2): . . . .

3. accomplish (paragraph 6): . . . .

A. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE APPROPRIATE WORDS. (2 pts)

total - foreign - visual - moral - corporal

1. My grandmother used to tell us stories that teach . . . . . .lessons.

2. The government encourages . . . . . .investments to create job opportunities.

B. PUT THE VERBS IN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE. (2 pts)

1. By this time next year, Morocco (launch) . . . . . its second surveillance satellite.

2. "(you/visit). . . . . the Louvre Museum when you were in Paris last summer?"

C. REWRITE THE SENTENCES BEGINNING WITH THE WORDS GIVEN. (3 pts)

1. Students will complete the first module in three weeks' time.

The first module . . . . . .

2. "Don't worry about the medical tests."

The nurse told the patient . . . . . .

3. Samuel came late to the party; he took the wrong road.

If Samuel hadn't taken the wrong road, he . . . . . .

D. FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH THE RIGHT WORDS FROM THE LISTS. (2 pts)

1. Do you know the boy . . . . . won the reading contest in your school?

a. who b. whose c. which

2. "I often forget . . . . . I put my keys," Sam told his neighbor.

a. how b. when c. where

E. GIVE THE CORRECT FORM OF THE WORDS IN BRACKETS. (2 pts)

The manager agreed to employ Emmy (immediate) . . . . . after the interview. He later gave her the

employment contract for (sign) . . . . . .

F. MATCH EACH EXPRESSION WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION. (2 pts)

Expressions	Functions
1. "Can I go on an excursion with my friends, dad?" Rosa asked. 2. "If only I could go to Russia to support the Moroccan football team!" 3. "You ought to think twice before changing your job."	a. expressing a wish b. asking for permission c. apologizing d. expressing opinion e. giving advice

1. …… 2. …… 3. …… 4. ……

TASK 1: (4 pts) Complete the following paragraph.

For my next birthday, I would like to have ……

as a gift for the following reasons. First, ……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

TASK 2: (6 pts)

Write a reply to the following email.

DO NOT WRITE YOUR NAME OR SIGN THE EMAIL

... You know, people do different things when they feel bored. Well, for me, I usually watch a movie or go for a walk. What about you?

Jane

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

TRUE / FALSE: (3 pts)

1. **True.** "It can transform in seconds from a car to a plane." (paragraph 1)
2. **True.** "They co-founded the company AeroMobil in 2010." (paragraph 2)
3. **False.** The 2015 crash involved "one of its prototypes", not AeroMobil 3.0, which was introduced in 2016. (paragraphs 3 and 4)

CHART FILLING: (2 pts)

Price: between 1.2 and 1.6 million dollars
Top speed as a car: 160 km/h
Top speed as a plane: 200 km/h
Maximum nonstop flight: 700 kilometers

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. At an international forum in Brussels (in 2016).
2. They need a pilot's license.
3. He is very positive / optimistic: he thinks it is the beginning of a new adventure which may change personal transport.

SENTENCE COMPLETION: (2 pts)

1. ...the achievement / development of the flying car (AeroMobil 3.0).
2. ...it has wings that fold, so it can be parked like a car.

WORD REFERENCE: (2 pts) 1. AeroMobil 3.0 (the flying car) 2. the vehicle (AeroMobil 3.0)

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (3 pts) 1. combination 2. brought to life 3. achieve

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

GAP FILLING: (2 pts) moral · foreign

VERB TENSES: (2 pts) 1. will have launched 2. Did you visit

REWRITING SENTENCES: (3 pts)

1. The first module **will be completed by students in three weeks' time**.
2. The nurse told the patient **not to worry about the medical tests**.
3. If Samuel hadn't taken the wrong road, he **wouldn't have come late to the party**.

GAP FILLING: (2 pts) 1. a. who 2. c. where

WORD FORMATION: (2 pts) 1. immediately 2. signature (or: signing)

MATCHING: (2 pts) 1. b. asking for permission 2. a. expressing a wish 3. e. giving advice 4. c. apologizing

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

The following criteria should be respected while scoring the writing tasks.

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Task 1: For my next birthday, I would like to have a laptop as a gift for the following reasons. First, I need it for my studies because I can search for information, write my homework and watch online lessons. Second, I want to learn skills such as programming and video editing, which will help me in the future. Third, a laptop lets me stay in touch with my friends and relatives who live abroad. Finally, I would take good care of it and use it wisely.

Task 2: Hi Jane, Thanks for your e-mail. You are right, people do different things when they feel bored. When I feel bored, I usually call a friend and we go out for a walk or play football. Sometimes I read a funny novel or watch a comedy because it makes me laugh and forget about my problems. I also like cooking something new with my mother; it is fun and I learn a skill. I think the best idea is to do something active instead of staying in front of the TV. What else do you do when you feel bored? Write back soon. Best wishes